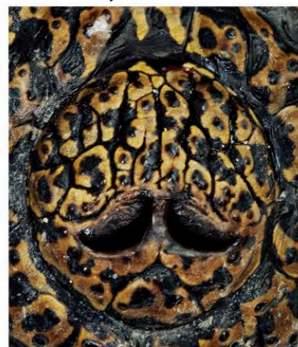


MUSCULAR LIMBS ∇>

This crocodile can race over short distances, powered by its strong rear legs. Because they are used for walking rather than swimming, the feet have no webbing between the toes.

**NOSTRILS** ∇

Paired nostrils are located on the nasal disc, an elevated pad of tissue at the end of the snout. Under water, the nostrils can be closed by valves.

**FORMIDABLE JAWS** ^

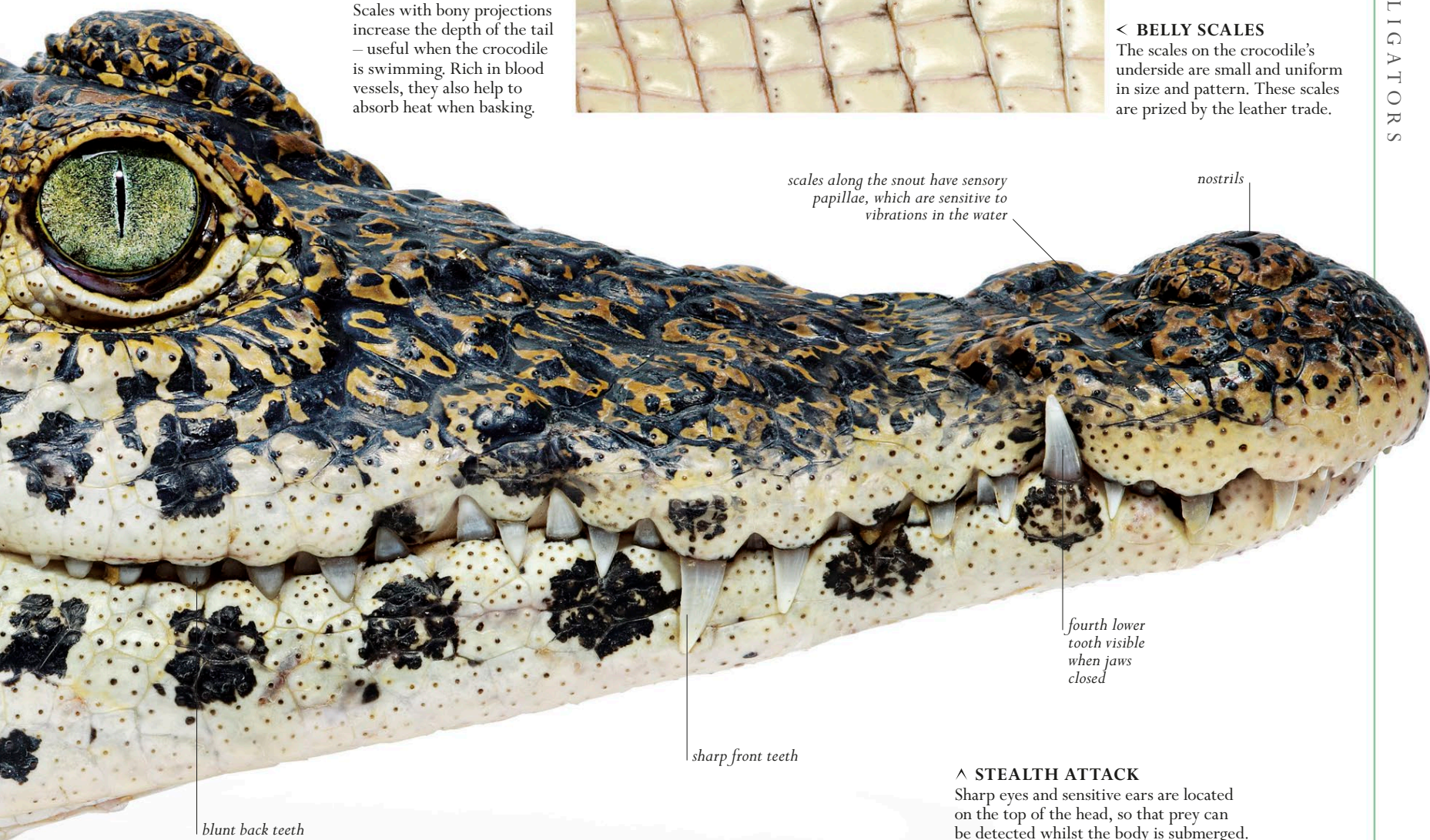
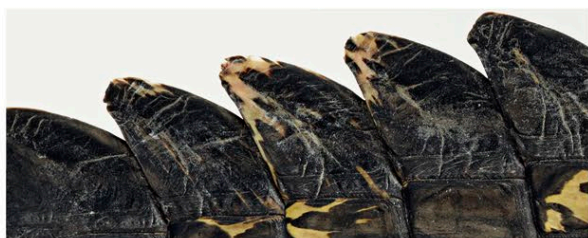
Crocodiles cannot chew their food, but they use their powerful jaws to grasp their prey. Sensitive taste buds on the tongue allow the crocodile to reject unpleasant tasting objects. Evaporation from the mouth cools the body.

BELLY SCALES <

The scales on the crocodile's underside are small and uniform in size and pattern. These scales are prized by the leather trade.

TAIL RIDGE ^

Scales with bony projections increase the depth of the tail – useful when the crocodile is swimming. Rich in blood vessels, they also help to absorb heat when basking.



scales along the snout have sensory papillae, which are sensitive to vibrations in the water

nostrils

fourth lower tooth visible when jaws closed

sharp front teeth

blunt back teeth are more robust than the front teeth

STEALTH ATTACK ^

Sharp eyes and sensitive ears are located on the top of the head, so that prey can be detected whilst the body is submerged. This enables the crocodile to take its victims by surprise. The long lower jaw can be closed with tremendous force to grasp struggling prey securely.